SEMPLICE ITALIAN KITCHEN | PASTA, RISOTTO & GNOCCHI

Authentic Roman Rigatoni alla Zozzona (30-Minute Carbonara & Amatriciana Hybrid)

PREP: 10 mins | COOK: 20 mins | TOTAL: 30 mins | SERVINGS: 4 servings | CALORIES: 640 kcal

INGREDIENTS

* 400g (14 oz) Bronze-die Rigatoni (cooked al dente in lightly salted water)
* 115g (4 oz) Guanciale (or Pancetta) (cut into 1/4-inch thick batons)
* 225g (8 oz) Italian Pork Sausage (casings removed, crumbled into bite-sized pieces)
* 1/2 small Yellow Onion or Shallot (finely diced)
* 60ml (1/4 cup) Dry White Wine (Frascati or Pinot Grigio) (for deglazing)
* 350g (1.5 cups) Crushed San Marzano Tomatoes or Passata
* 4 large Fresh Egg Yolks (at room temperature)
* 85g (1 cup) Pecorino Romano DOP (finely grated, plus extra for serving)
* 1.5 tsp Coarsely Cracked Black Pepper

STEP-BY-STEP INSTRUCTIONS

Step 1: Crisp the Guanciale & Reserve Half (8 mins)

Place the guanciale batons in a cold, wide skillet and set over medium-low heat. Cook slowly for 7-8 minutes until the fat renders and the edges turn golden and crisp. Use a slotted spoon to transfer half of the crispy guanciale to a small bowl for topping at the end, leaving all rendered fat in the pan.

Step 2: Brown the Italian Sausage & Deglaze (6 mins)

Add the diced onion and crumbled Italian pork sausage to the skillet over medium-high heat. Sear for 5-6 minutes, breaking up the sausage until deeply browned. Pour in the dry white wine, scraping up the browned fond from the bottom of the pan until the wine evaporates.

Step 3: Simmer the Tomato Rag & Boil Rigatoni (10 mins)

Stir in the crushed San Marzano tomatoes and 1 teaspoon of cracked black pepper. Lower heat and simmer gently for 10 minutes while you boil the rigatoni in lightly salted water (use half your normal salt since Pecorino and guanciale are naturally salty).

Step 4: Whisk the Egg Yolk & Pecorino Carbocrema (2 mins)

In a heatproof mixing bowl, whisk the 4 room-temperature egg yolks with the finely grated Pecorino Romano and remaining black pepper. Whisk in 2 tablespoons of warm (not boiling) pasta water and 1 tablespoon of warm tomato sauce from the skillet to temper the yolks into a smooth paste.

Step 5: Marry Off Heat for a Glossy Emulsion (3 mins)

Transfer the al dente rigatoni into the tomato-sausage skillet and toss for 1 minute over high heat with a splash of pasta water. Remove the skillet completely from the stove and wait 60 seconds for bubbling to stop. Pour in the tempered egg-Pecorino paste, tossing rapidly with tongs until a creamy brick-orange emulsion coats the rigatoni. Top with the reserved crispy guanciale and serve!

NONNA'S CHEF TIPS:

- Salt your pasta boiling water at only 50% strength-between the cured guanciale, seasoned pork sausage, and aged Pecorino Romano, the sauce already carries plenty of savory salinity.
- Tempering the egg-Pecorino paste with a spoonful of warm tomato sauce before adding it to the off-heat pan makes it virtually impossible to scramble the eggs.